PERCENTILERS

PREPARE ● PERSEVERE ● PERFORM

BY SEVEN TIME CAT 100%ILER

FREE EBOOK — 2024 EDITION

TOP 5

THINGS TO DO

NOW

IF YOU WANT

99+ PERCENTILE

IN CAT

Pranshul Verma

Founder, Percentilers · 7× CAT 100%iler

57.8%	<5%	7×
Percentilers' conversion	Industry average	CAT 100%ile

READING | CALC SPEED | MIND GAMES | KNOW EXAM | MOCK STRATEGY

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BONUS Your 30-Day Quick-Start Checklist

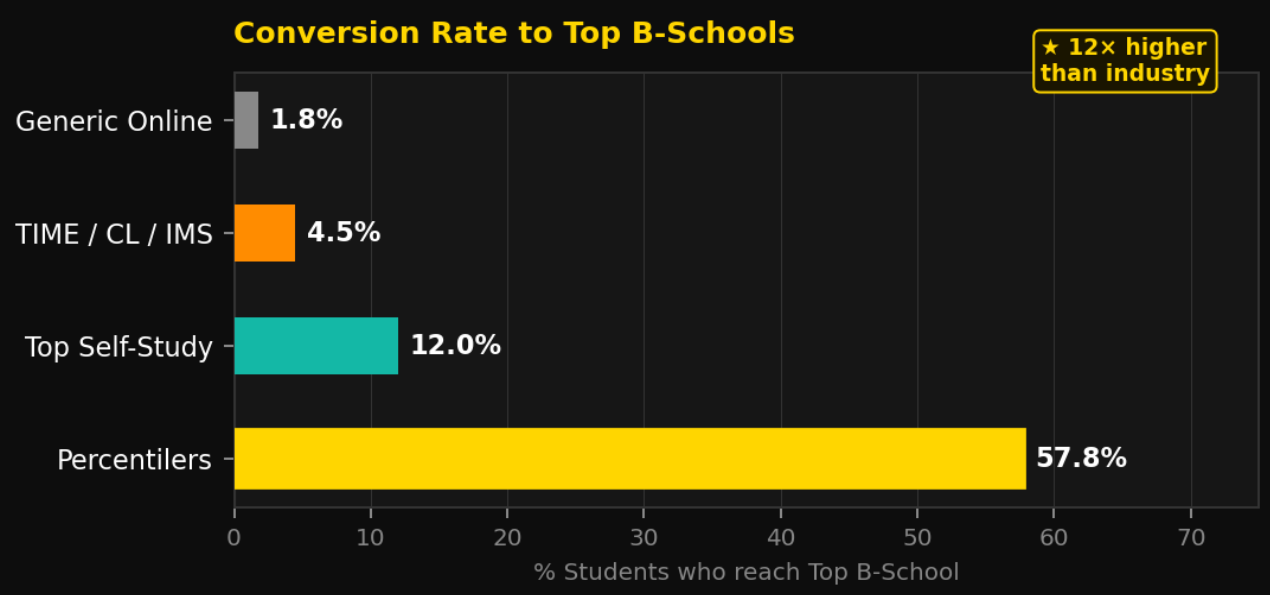
Free resource from Percentilers. Share it with every CAT aspirant you know.

INTRODUCTION

Why Most CAT Coaching Will Never Tell You This

Here's the uncomfortable truth: big-brand coaching factories are optimised for enrolments, not results. Their business model rewards sign-ups, not IIM calls. That's why their conversion rate to top B-schools sits under 5%. Ours at Percentilers is above 57%. The five habits in this ebook explain the difference.

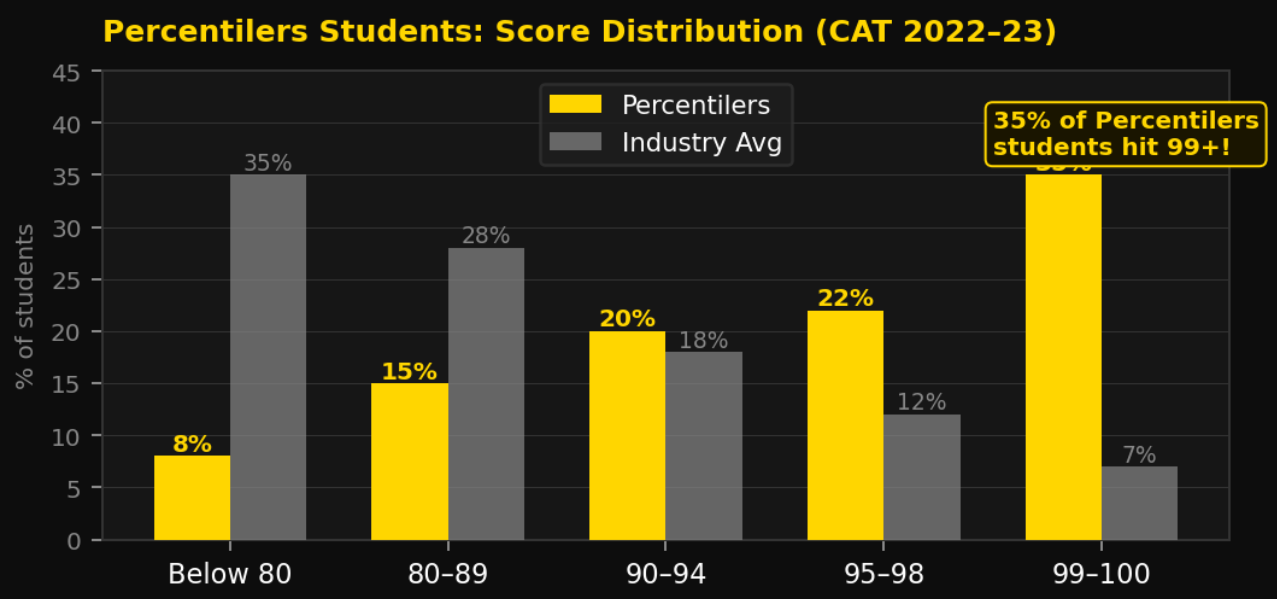
> ***❝ Ask yourself WHY you want this. Your answer will be the fuel that keeps you going when everything feels impossible.***



Conversion rate to top B-schools: Percentilers vs industry. Source: internal data + publicly stated industry figures.

The five things in this ebook are not hacks. They are structural changes in how you think, read, calculate, and perform under pressure.

57.8%	<5%	7×
Percentilers' conversion rate	Industry average	CAT 100%ile by author



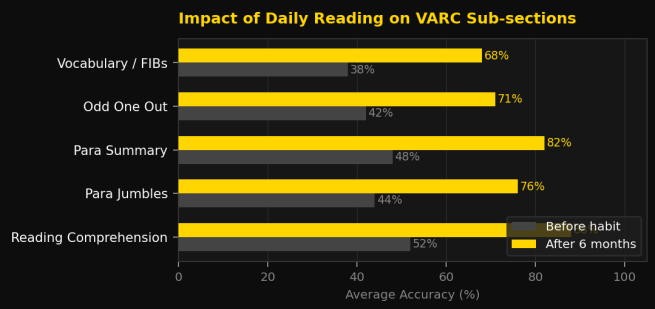
Percentilers student score distribution vs industry average. 35% of Percentilers students score 99+.

THING 01

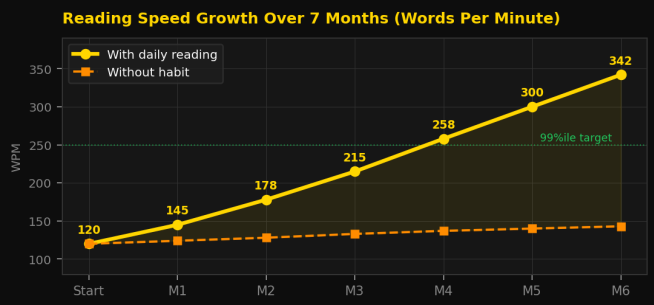
Build the Reading Habit

Three Ways That Actually Work

In 12+ years of training CAT aspirants, one pattern dominates: students who crack VARC at 99%ile are voracious readers. Not because they had perfect grammar — but because reading builds a subconscious language sense no rule can replicate. I have trained students from Hindi-medium backgrounds who hit 99%ile in VARC purely through a consistent reading habit.



Average accuracy improvement across VARC sub-sections after 6 months of daily reading.



Reading speed trajectory (WPM): with vs without daily habit. Target: 250+ WPM for 99%ile.

01 Start With What You Love, Not The Hindu Editorial

Jumping straight into dense editorials kills a reading habit before it starts. Your brain resists boring content. Start with whatever genuinely interests you — a cricket blog, thriller novel, tech forum, travel piece. The goal right now is simply to make reading feel natural. After 4–6 weeks, gradually introduce The Hindu, The Economist, and Aeon Essays.

02 Never Stop Mid-Sentence to Google a Word

Stopping to look up every unfamiliar word destroys your reading flow and trains dependence on external help. Instead, highlight unknown words and keep reading — context gives you 80% of meaning anyway. Review highlights at session end. This spaced-repetition method builds vocabulary far more effectively than dictionary lookup.

03 Practise Speed-Reading Under Artificial Time Pressure

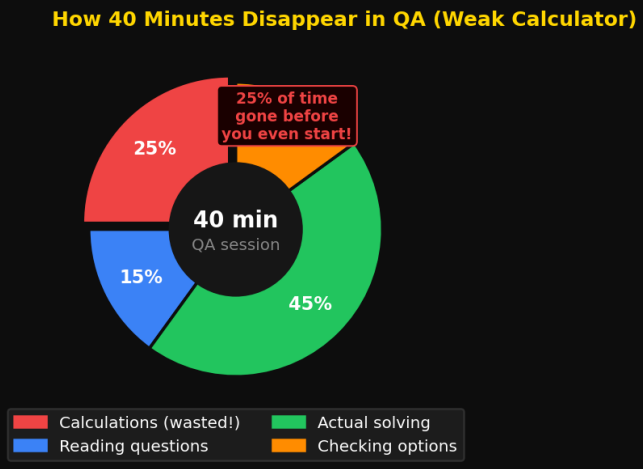
Start an article when you have only 5–7 minutes before a meeting or meal. The ticking clock forces your brain to process faster. Over 3–4 weeks this becomes your default reading gear. Target: increase WPM by 20% every two weeks while keeping comprehension above 80%. A reading speed of 250+ WPM is achievable and transformative for VARC.

THING 02

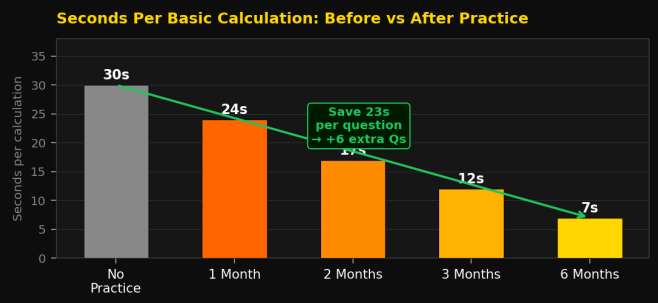
Calculation Speed: The Hidden Score Killer

And How Traffic Can Fix It

If you take 30 seconds per basic calculation and attempt 20 QA questions, you waste 600 seconds — 10 full minutes doing nothing but arithmetic inside a 40-minute window. That's 25% of your total time gone before you even think about problem-solving. Most aspirants never notice this because they're too focused on concepts.



How 40 QA minutes are actually spent for a weak calculator.



Time per basic calculation with consistent daily practice. Save 23s per question → 6 extra Qs.

01 Addition is the Foundation of Everything

Every arithmetic operation — multiplication, squares, percentages — can be reduced to fast addition. Before learning any Vedic maths trick, make addition lightning fast. 50 mental additions of random 2-digit pairs every morning before any prep material. This alone transforms your QA performance within 6 weeks.

02 The Number Plate Trick (This One Actually Works)

Every vehicle on Indian roads has a 4-digit number plate. During every commute, split that 4-digit number into two 2-digit pairs and add them. DL 4C 3847 → 38+47=85. Zero extra time from your day, dramatic improvement in mental addition, and — bonus — you'll honk less because you're too busy calculating.

03 One Vedic Maths Trick Per Week

Don't binge-learn 20 tricks in a weekend and forget them all by Wednesday. One new trick per week, practiced every day until it's automatic. Good starters: multiplying numbers near 100, squaring numbers ending in 5, the 11× shortcut. App recommendation: Mathtrick or King of Maths.

04 Tables to 30, Squares to 50, Cubes to 20

These must be cold-recalled — not slowly-counted — within 2 seconds. At least 3–4 QA questions per CAT slot become significantly faster with instant recall of squares and cubes. Write them on a sticky note above your desk.

Calculation Speed: Impact on QA Performance

Metric	Weak Calculator	Strong Calculator
Time per calculation	~30 seconds	~7 seconds
Total calc time (20 Qs)	600 sec (10 min)	140 sec (2.3 min)
Time saved for solving	—	+8 minutes freed
Extra questions possible	—	+5 to +7 Qs
Typical QA percentile	55–65 %ile	85–95 %ile

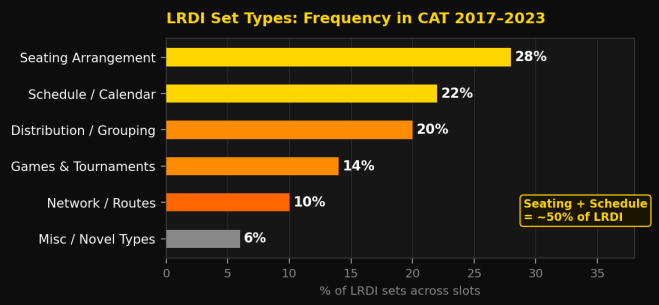
Direct impact of calculation speed on QA performance: weak vs strong calculator.

THING 03

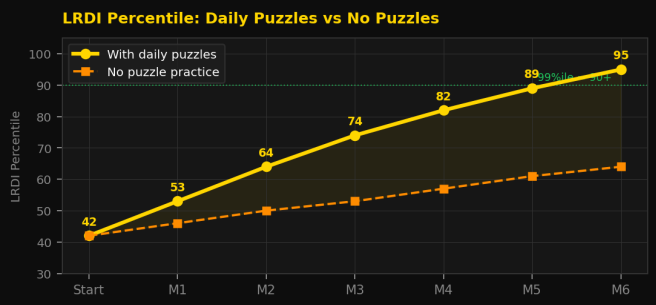
Play Mind Games to Ace LRDI

Building Analytical Thinking, Not Just Practising Sets

LRDI is not a knowledge test. It's an analytical thinking test. You cannot mug up the approach to a novel puzzle — you have to develop the thinking muscle that attacks unknown problems confidently. The aspirants who score 99%ile in LRDI love the problem-solving process. That love is trainable.



LRDI set types by frequency in CAT 2017–2023. Seating Arrangement + Schedule = ~50% of all sets.



LRDI percentile trajectory: daily puzzle practice vs none. Gap widens dramatically after month 3.

01 Solve Puzzles Daily — Not Just CAT Sets

Sudoku, Kakuro, Cross-Sum, Futoshiki, Killer Sudoku, KenKen — 15 minutes daily at medium difficulty. Work on reducing solve time each week. Over three months you'll notice a qualitative shift in how you approach unfamiliar CAT sets. The analytical muscle built here carries directly into LRDI performance.

02 Unlearn Rote-Learning Mode

Board exams reward memorisation with zero analytical skill. If you've spent 15 years being rewarded for mugging, your brain reaches for memory when it should reach for logic. Every time you catch yourself trying to memorise an LRDI technique, stop. Ask 'why does this work?' until you understand the underlying logic.

03 Download and Practise Real CAT Papers from 1990

LRDI has no fixed syllabus. The only way to understand what 'CAT-type' reasoning looks like is to practise on actual CAT papers. Download from 2IIM, TestFunda, or percentilers.in/resources. After each set: what constraint made it hard? What information unlocked the solution?

04 Build Inner Interest Deliberately

The aspirants who score 99%ile in LRDI genuinely enjoy it. If you dread opening LRDI, that dread is the real obstacle. Trick yourself into liking it: celebrate small wins, maintain a 'solved sets' count, challenge a friend to beat your time.

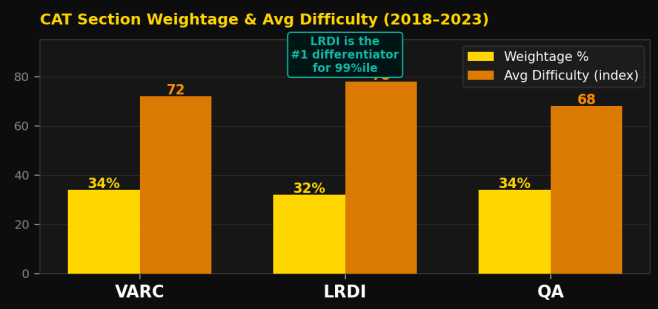
THING 04

Know Your Exam Before You Start Preparing

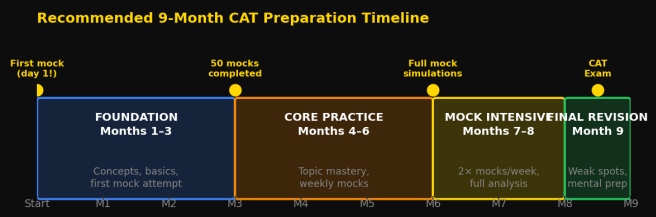
The Step Most Aspirants Skip Entirely

More than half of all CAT aspirants who prepare for 6–9 months have never sat down with a real CAT paper from a previous year and attempted it under timed conditions. They study topics in isolation without ever understanding what the actual exam looks like, feels like, or demands from them.

> ***❝ You wouldn't train for a marathon without knowing the route. Know your exam before you prepare for it.***



CAT section weightage and average difficulty index (2018–2023). LRDI is the key differentiator for 99%ile.



Recommended 9-month preparation timeline with phase milestones.

Topic Priority Matrix: Frequency × Your Strength

Topic Priority Matrix: map your weak areas against CAT frequency to build a selective study plan.

■ Download Past CAT Papers (1990–Present)

2IIM, TestFunda, or percentilers.in/resources — at least 10 years of real papers. Observe how the exam has evolved, especially post-2015 computer-based format.

■ Attempt a Full Paper Cold — Before Any Prep

Honest baseline. Most aspirants start at 60–70%ile, not zero. That's great news — it tells you where the gap actually is.

■ Study the Percentile vs Score Chart

99%ile does NOT mean attempting every question. It often means 55–60% attempt rate with very high accuracy. Study the score-percentile mapping for the last 5 years.

■ Understand Organic vs Inorganic Prep

Inorganic (formulae, tricks) responds fast to practice. Organic (reading speed, vocabulary, calculation fluency, analytical thinking) takes their own time — start these on Day 1 of preparation.

■ Build Topic-Priority List: Frequency × Strength

High-frequency weak areas = top priority. Low-frequency weak areas = skip or skim. Selective study is not laziness — it's strategy.

THING 05

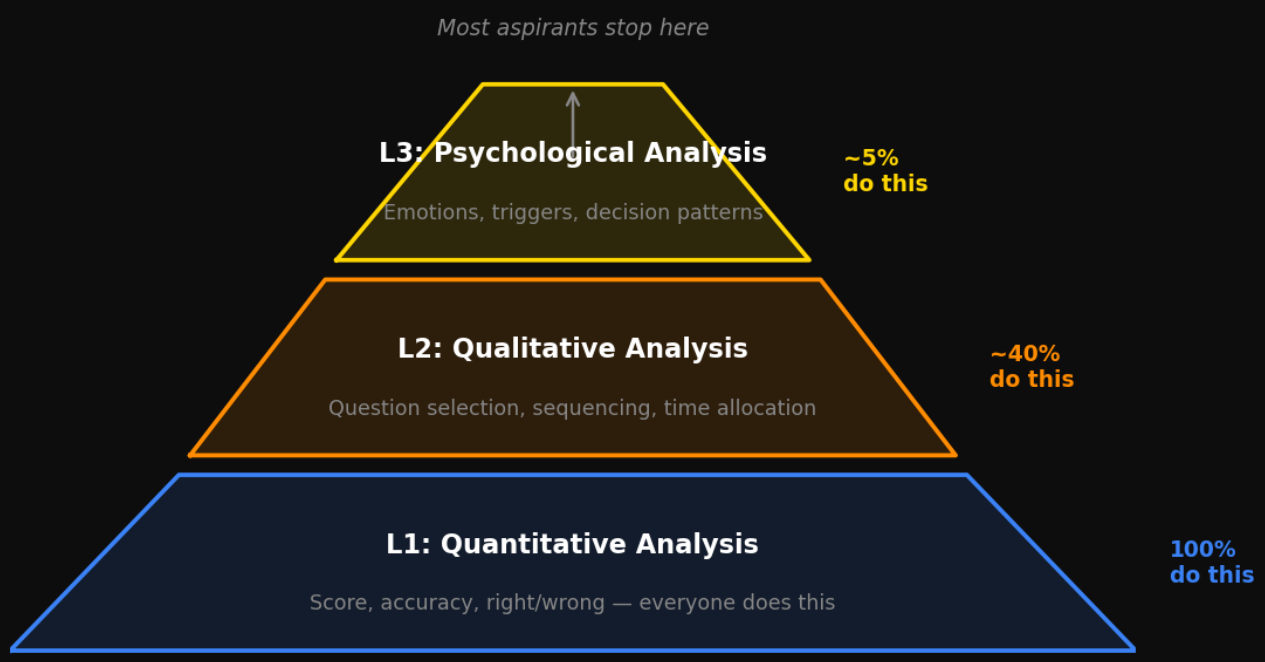
Mock Tests Are Not About Your Score

A 3-Layer Analysis Framework That Toppers Use

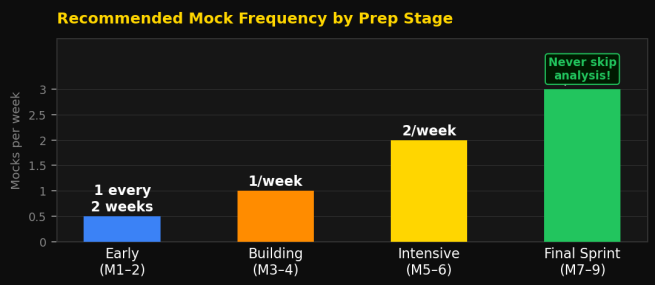
I've heard every excuse: 'I just joined', 'I'm not ready', 'I'll start after the syllabus is done'. Let me be direct: no excuse is valid. When I was preparing for CAT, I took a mock on Day 2 — before studying a single topic. The score was terrible. That was exactly the point.

> ***❝ A mock test is like an iceberg: the score you see is 10% of its value. The 90% below the surface — the analysis — is what actually makes you better.***

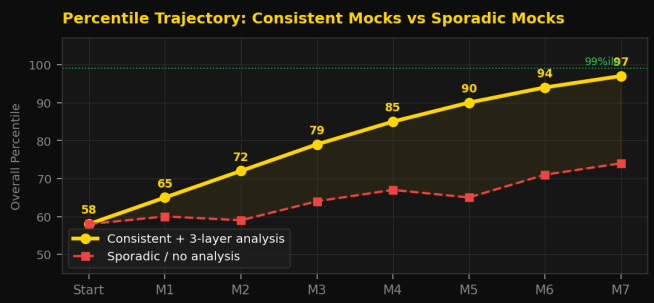
The 3-Layer Mock Analysis Framework



The 3-Layer Mock Analysis Framework. Most aspirants stop at L1. Toppers do all three after every single mock.



Recommended mock frequency by prep stage. Ramp up progressively as exam approaches.



Percentile trajectory: consistent mocks + 3-layer analysis vs sporadic mocks.

L1 Quantitative Analysis — What Everyone Does

Score, accuracy, right/wrong per topic, cut-off comparison. Necessary but insufficient. Do this within 30 minutes of finishing the mock.

L2 Qualitative Analysis — What Most People Skip

Did I pick the right questions? Was my attempt sequence optimal? Did I correctly estimate difficulty? Did I waste time on an un-leavable question? Spend 60–90 minutes here. This layer transforms a mock from a test into a learning session.

L3 Psychological Analysis — What Toppers Do

What was I feeling at the 20-minute mark? When did panic set in? What triggered silly errors? Why did I stay on a question I should have left? Write answers in a mock journal after every test. This is the difference between 92 and 99 percentile.

BONUS

Your 30-Day Quick-Start Checklist

Do These First — Before Anything Else

Print this out. Put it on your wall. Check off each item.

WEEK 1 — KNOW YOUR BATTLEFIELD

- Download CAT papers from 2018–2023 (minimum 5 papers)
- Attempt one full paper cold, under timed conditions
- Study the Percentile vs Score chart for last 5 years
- Make your initial Topic Priority 2×2 grid
- Join the Percentilers Telegram: t.me/percentilersCAT

WEEK 2 — BUILD YOUR ENGINE

- Start daily 30-min reading (any content you genuinely enjoy)
- Begin number-plate addition during every commute
- Learn multiplication tables up to 30
- Start one Sudoku per day (medium difficulty)
- Take your first mock — don't wait for 'readiness'

WEEK 3 — CALIBRATE

- Do your first 3-Layer Mock Analysis (L1, L2, L3)
- Upgrade reading to one editorial or long-form article daily
- Learn first Vedic maths trick (multiplying near 100)
- Identify your top 3 weak areas from the mock
- Build selective study plan: topic weight × your strength

WEEK 4 — ACCELERATE

- Take Mock #2, compare L2 analysis with Week 3 mock
- Upgrade puzzles to Kakuro or Killer Sudoku
- Collect 5 new vocabulary words per day from reading
- Track your progress: reading speed, calc speed, mock score

- Explore the full Percentilers curriculum at percentilers.in

FINALLY

A Word From Pranshul

I wrote this ebook because I genuinely want you to crack CAT. I have seen too many brilliant students fail this exam for reasons that had nothing to do with their intelligence — and everything to do with their preparation approach.

The five things in this ebook are not revolutionary. But almost nobody does all five, consistently, for 6–9 months. That's the actual secret. Consistency over cleverness. Process over shortcuts.

> ***❝ Start your reading habit today, do number-plate calculations on your next commute, and take a mock this weekend. Those three actions will put you ahead of 70% of CAT aspirants right now.***

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